



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Chesterton Academy of St. Ignatius of Loyola Catholic School
School Website: <https://stignatiuskaukauna.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Chesterton Academy of St. Ignatius Loyola Catholic School (WI 54130) presents a robust Catholic classical education that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. Public-facing materials emphasize a Catholic, theology-forward foundation, an integrated classical curriculum built around the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a love of Great Books, contemplative pedagogy (Scholé) alongside Socratic inquiry, and a high value on virtue formation, character, and communal life. The school also foregrounds liturgical and communal practices (Mass, adoration, pilgrimages, retreats), a living-faculty model, and deep parent/community partnership (open visits, formation opportunities, family involvement).

Key signals across categories indicate a CLASSICAL orientation, with explicit references to truth, goodness, beauty; a formation-focused telos; a Trivium-based curriculum; Socratic pedagogy in upper levels; lower-school memory/repetition through chant and song; a living-faculty and mentorship ethos; and strong parental-partnering with ongoing opportunities for family formation. The presence of Catechesis and a catechetical, liturgical life further anchors the religious-metaphysical foundation.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Public materials consistently frame education within a Catholic, theological worldview, with explicit statements about integrating faith into all subjects and forming disciples of Christ. - References to catechesis, Catechism of the Catholic Church, Mass, Eucharistic Adoration, liturgical life, and Catholic identity (Newman Guide recognition) appear in multiple pages. - The school emphasizes a transcendently oriented curriculum (truth, goodness, beauty) and a Catholic worldview that orients academic work toward God's truth.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic, theology, Catechesis, Mass, liturgy, adoration, Catechesis of the Good Shepherd (CGS), Newman Guide, faith, sacred, catechesis, Church, catechism, prayer, liturgical rhythm, transcendentals (truth/goodness/beauty).

- Negative keywords: none evident in public materials (no explicit secular, relativist, or value-neutral framing observed). - Frequency note: The materials frequently interweave Catholic identity with classroom learning, giving high density to religious foundations.

Why this rating - The consistent, explicit integration of Catholic theology, liturgical practices, catechesis, and a liturgical/community life places this category squarely in CLASSICAL territory, with theology as a governing/discursive framework for learning. The presence of Great Books and a transcendently oriented curriculum complements the religious grounding. See evidence above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Emphasis on formation of virtue and wisdom; education as formation rather than mere information. The mission centers on forming virtuous leaders and joyful disciples, not primarily job training. - The curriculum aims at truth, goodness, and beauty, and frames education as formation of character and human excellence. - The public materials describe teleology toward virtue, wisdom, and moral imagination consistent with the classical telos.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, human flourishing, telos, true/good/beautiful, liberal education, great conversation, moral imagination, virtuous life, timeless truths, Logos, contemplation. - Negative keywords: none observed (no explicit emphasis on workforce preparation, college placement as sole aim, or highly secular career-readiness framing in the core description). The emphasis remains formation-focused. - Frequency note: Formation-related terms dominate the language about purpose and goals.

Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as the core aim of education, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for purpose and telos. The absence (in their public materials) of a primary emphasis on job-ready skills or purely career-prep supports CLASSICAL classification.

Element 3: School Curriculum — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Explicit Trivium framing: grammar, logic, rhetoric stages (3K–4, grades 5–8, grades 9–12). This is a hallmark of classical curriculum design. - Great Books and the Great Conversation emphasized via reading lists (Homer, Plato, Aristotle, Virgil, Dante, Shakespeare, Dostoyevsky, Chesterton, etc.) and integrated study across history, literature, philosophy, and theology. - History taught as a unifying thread across disciplines, not just social studies; integration of disciplines (history, literature, philosophy, theology) in a braided curriculum. - Latin (two years) and classical languages emphasized; curriculum materials reference Chesterton Academy Curriculum Overviews and Latin study.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, Western canon, Trivium, Latin, history as integrated, interdisciplinary/harmony of subjects, wonder, sacred tradition, Catholic worldview, catechesis. - Negative keywords: the candidate negatives from the lexicon (e.g., “project-based learning first,” “STEM-first framing”) do not appear as governing themes in the public materials; rather, the materials emphasize a classical/canon-driven structure. - Frequency note: Strong presence of classical curriculum signals; multiple references to Trivium, Great Books, Latin, integrated history/literature/philosophy/theology.

Why this rating - The curriculum is explicitly built on the classical trinity (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books, history-integrated pedagogy, and Latin, with a braided, interdisciplinary approach and a sacramental/theological frame. This matches CLASSICAL criteria.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Pedagogy includes both contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) and rigorous Socratic discussion in upper levels; seminar-style inquiry is described, with opportunities for rhetoric and public speaking. - Lower grammar years emphasize singing, chanting, memorization, and deep memory work (recitation) as core methods. - Upper levels employ Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates, with trained rhetoric and opportunities for speeches. - The pedagogy is described as a classical pedagogy, with “the ten essential principles of classical pedagogy” linked on the site.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminar, dialectic, questioning, dialogue-based instruction, scholé, contemplation, wonder, rhetoric, debate, memory work, recitation, liturgical integration, catechesis. - Negative keywords: the lexicon warns against over-reliance on project-based or experiential-only approaches; the public materials do not foreground project-based-only pedagogy; instead, they emphasize memory, recitation, Socratic inquiry, and rhetoric. This aligns with CLASSICAL pedagogy.

- Frequency note: Strong alignment with both rest-focused memory work and high-level Socratic/rhetoric pedagogy.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a clear blend of contemplative/Scholé practices with Socratic seminars and rhetoric training, including memory-based lower-grammar methods—precisely the dual pedagogy expected in a classical model.

Element 5: School Faculty — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The public materials describe faculty as model teachers and mentors; the living curriculum concept is promoted, with “faculty as the core” and “portrait of what a teacher should be.” The school emphasizes a close-knit, mission-driven faculty culture. - References to a Catholic, classical school community where teachers are partners with students and families, forming a “living curriculum.” - The school highlights families and teachers as a connected community and mentions the teachers’ role in liturgical and spiritual formation in addition to academics.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, faculty as core, portrait of teacher and student, collegial culture, teacher as guide, partnership with families. - Negative keywords: The lexicon’s potential negatives (e.g., “facilitators on the side,” purely certification-driven jargon) are not evident in the site materials; rather, the emphasis is on teacher-mentor relationships and classical formation. - Frequency note: High density of faculty-centered, mentorship-oriented language; consistent with CLASSICAL expectations.

Why this rating - The “living curriculum” concept and emphasis on model teachers/mentors point to a CLASSICAL faculty model. The presence of a strong, mission-aligned faculty culture and family partnerships reinforces this placement.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnerships with parents as co-teachers and family formation; there are ongoing opportunities for parent engagement (website resources, book studies, gatherings). The campus is open to visits and involvement. - The materials indicate active parent access (tours, admissions process) and a culture of parental involvement in the formation of virtue and learning. - The school situates itself within parish networks and Catholic community life (Mass, sacraments, campus/community life).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, open campus, parent book studies, classical family culture, home-school alignment, parish connection, community involvement. - Negative keywords: none observed in public materials (the lexicon warns against consumer-language Framing; the site emphasizes formation and partnership rather than consumerism). - Frequency note: Strong, repeated emphasis on parent partnership and family formation.

Why this rating - The school builds parental partnerships, parent formation opportunities, and open-campus access, all of which align with CLASSICAL expectations for parents as co-educators and engaged community members.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, Chesterton Academy of St. Ignatius Loyola Catholic School demonstrates a comprehensive CLASSICAL orientation across religious foundations, purpose and goal, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable (the school is classified as CLASSICAL across all six categories). No broad needle-moving changes are required to achieve full alignment with classical criteria, though ongoing documentation of outcomes (e.g., student formation, Great-Books-based assessment, or faculty development aligned to classical pedagogy) could further strengthen the public-facing articulation of the classical model.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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